

Ruan van Mazijk

Technical Coordinator

C4 EcoSolutions & TAG International

ruan.vanmazijk@c4es.co.za



Ecologist, evolutionary biologist,
botanist, data visualiser, writer

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Languages	English (native), Afrikaans (fluent), R (10 years)	MSc in Biological Sciences (UCT)	2023
Tools	R Markdown, L ^A T _E X, bash, git, GitHub, MS Office	Under Profs Muasya, Verboom & West	
Skills	public speaking, technical writing, copyediting, statistical modelling, data manipulation, visualisation, GIS (in R), phylogeny inference & comparative methods	BSc Hons in Biological Sciences (UCT)	2017
		With distinction	
		BSc in Ecology & Evolution, Applied Biology (UCT)	2016
		With distinction in both majors & the degree	

Work experience

C4 EcoSolutions & TAG International

Technical Coordinator

Apr 2025–

Quality assurance for climate change
adaptation & mitigation documents
Scientific support (ecology)
Research, writing & editorial support
Preparation of proposals & bids

C4 EcoSolutions

Ecologist, Editorial & Training Specialist 2024–2025

Research, Publishing & Training Officer 2023–2024

Research & Publishing Intern Feb–Aug 2023

University of Cape Town (UCT)

Teaching Assistant & Tutor (various, part time)

Dept. Biological Sciences 2018–2022

Dept. Statistical Sciences 2016–2020

Dept. Mathematics & Applied Mathematics 2015

Research Assistant (various, part time)

Dept. of Biological Sciences 2015–2018

Professional memberships

South Afr. Association of Botanists 2017–

Southern Afr. Society for Systematic Biology 2018–

↔ Council student representative 2019–2021

Workshop instruction

Postgraduate

Data wrangling & manipulation in R (Organiser, lead, for Dept. Biological Sciences, UCT) 2019

Teaching Biodiversity for High School Life Science Teachers (Speaker, for SDU¹) 2019

Scientific study design & data analysis in R (Tutor, for SEEC²-ACCESS³) 2018, 2019

Teaching assistance

Undergraduate

Angiosperm diversity 2018, 2019, 2022

Principles of ecology & evolution 2019, 2020

Scientific study design & data analysis in R 2017–2020

Introductory statistics in R 2016–2018

References

C4 EcoSolutions

Dr Anthony J. Mills anthony.mills@c4es.co.za

Barbara Ikin barbara.ikin@c4es.co.za

Dr Robbert Duker robbert.duker@c4es.co.za

Dept. Biological Sciences, UCT

Prof A. Muthama Muasya muthama.muasya@uct.ac.za

Prof G. Anthony Verboom tony.verboom@uct.ac.za

Prof Adam G. West adam.west@uct.ac.za

Prof Michael D. Cramer michael.cramer@uct.ac.za

Funding & awards

UCT Postgraduate Publication Incentive Funding 2023

NRF Innovation Masters Scholarship 2019

SAAB MSc Student Bursary (inaugural recipient) 2018, 2019

UCT Once-Off Award 2018

UCT Dorothy Cameron Scholarship 2018

UCT Masters Research Scholarship 2018

NRF Innovation Honours Scholarship 2017

SAAB Honours Scholarship 2017

UCT Science Faculty Scholarship 2015, 2016

Conferences, talks & press

SASSB XVI (3rd Best Student Presentation) 2023

SASSB & GENUS⁴ sponsored attendance

SAAB Postgraduate Virtual Symposium 2022

MEDECOS XVII (NRF sponsored virtual attendance) 2022

IBS⁵ Early Career Biogeographers Conference 2021

iDiv⁶ Joint Recruitment Symposium 2020

SAAB-AMA-SASSB IVXV Joint Congress 2019

Best Systematics MSc Presentation (tied)

UCT Travel Grant for attendance

satRday Cape Town (Attended) 2018

The John Maytham Show, CapeTalk (Interview) 2018

Harvesting Storm Water

Pint of Science Cape Town 2018

Biodiversity & Environmental Change in the CFR⁷ 2017

¹SDU: Schools Development Unit, UCT

²SEEC: Centre for Statistics in Ecology, the Environment & Conservation, UCT

³ACCESS: Applied Centre for Climate & Earth Systems, NRF

⁴GENUS: DSI-NRF Centre of Excellence in Palaeosciences

⁵IBS: International Biogeography Society

⁶iDiv: German Centre for Integrative Biodiversity Research, Halle-Jena-Leipzig

⁷CFR: Cape Floristic Region

Publications

- Van Mazijk**, McGregor, Duker, Butynski, Schutgens, Schleicher, Graham, Rees, Eldabaa, Mohamed, Almalki & Lee. Arthropod communities in desert ecosystems of Alula County, Saudi Arabia. Submitted to *Zoology in the Middle East*. 2025
- Ismail, McGregor, Duker, Liversage, Mills, **van Mazijk**, Butynski, Schutgens, Schleicher, Graham, Rees, Eldabaa, Mohamed, Almalki & Lee. Organic carbon stocks in aboveground biomass and soils in hyper-arid AlUla County, Saudi Arabia. Submitted to *Carbon Balance and Management*. 2025
- McGregor, Ismail, Duker, Liversage, Maharaj, Mills, **van Mazijk**, Butynski, Schutgens, Schleicher, Graham, Rees, Eldabaa, Mohamed, Almalki & Lee. Allometric equations for hyper-arid desert plant species of AlUla County, Saudi Arabia. Submitted to *Carbon Balance and Management*. 2025
- Mills & **van Mazijk**. Permutation tests to identify significant constraint or promotion within biological scatterplots. *Ecol. Evol.* 14. 10.1002/ece3.70584 2024
- Jiménez-Mejías, Manzano, Gowda, Krell, Lin, Martín-Bravo *et al.* Protecting stable biological nomenclatural systems enables universal communication: A collective international appeal. *BioScience*. 74(7). 10.1093/biosci/biae043. 2024
- Mills, **van Mazijk**, Allen & Strydom. Soil geochemistry & constraint of tree seedlings immediately after germination on *Macrotermes* termite mounds in the Kruger National Park, South Africa. *Ecol. Evol.* 14(5). 10.1002/ece3.11348. 2024
- Van Mazijk**, West, Verboom, Elliott, Bureš & Muasya. Genome size variation in Cape schoenoid sedges (Cyperaceae: Schoeneae) & its ecophysiological consequences. *Am. J. Bot.* 111(8). 10.1002/ajb2.16315 2024
- Mills, Duker, Lechmere-Oertel, **van Mazijk** & Potts. Science is the fuel required for lifting ecosystem restoration into the orbit of hundreds of millions of hectares. *Front. Cons. Sci.* 4. 10.3389/fcosc.2023.1283262. 2023
- Van Mazijk**, Cramer & Verboom. Environmental heterogeneity explains contrasting plant species richness between the South African Cape & southwestern Australia. *J. Biogeog.* 48. 10.1111/jbi.14118. 2021
- Elliott, **van Mazijk**, Barrett, Bruhl, Joly, Muthaphuli, Wilson & Muasya. Global dispersal & diversification of the genus *Schoenus* (Cyperaceae) from the Western Australian biodiversity hotspot. *J. Syst. Evol.* 59(4). 10.1111/jse.12742. 2021
- Elliott, Laidler, Muasya, Muthaphuli & **van Mazijk**. Solving the sedge mystery. *Veld & Flora* 105(3):20–25. 2019
- Cramer, Wootton, **van Mazijk** & Verboom. New regionally-modelled soil layers improve prediction of vegetation type relative to that based on global soil models. *Div. Distrib.* 25(11). 10.1111/ddi.12973. 2019
- Van Mazijk**, Smyth, Weideman & West. Isotopic tracing of stormwater in the urban Liesbeek River. *Water SA* 44(4). 10.4314/wsa.v44i4.16. 2018

Research assistance

- Schoenus* (Cyperaceae) field assistance, collections & hydroponics for Dr T.L. Elliott & Prof A.M. Muasya (UCT) 2018
- Mimetes* & *Leucospermum* (Proteaceae) population monitoring for Dr J.A. Slingsby (UCT, SAEON) 2017
- Legume symbiotic rhizobia collections & culturing for Dr M. Dlodlu (University of Swaziland) 2015